

Class 20

Market Power and Antitrust

Part IV — Governing Capitalism's Consequences

The rise of markups in the U.S., 1955-present



1: Average Markups. Output elasticities θ_{st} from estimated production functions using industry and sector-specific (2 digit). Average is revenue weighted. Evolution 1955-

Since 1980 there has been a steady increase to 1.61. In 2016, the average markup is 61% over marginal cost, compared to 21% in 1980. In Online Appendix 5 we report the distribution of individual firms' markups.

In broad terms, there are three sources that can account for this rise in aggregate markups:

Corporate profits as a share of national income

